acquire influence in the political, military and also ideological fields. West Germany's ruling circles are stubbornly resisting the conduction of a treaty on the establishment of equitable relations between the GDR and the FRG on the basis of international law: Such a policy contradicts the requirements for genuine guarantees of peace and European security.

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According to Günter Schabowski, these endless rants were hardly conducive to rapprochement and caused irreparable damage to Honecker's fragile relationship with Ulbricht. 'Against the dialogue in Kassel and Erfurt promoted by Ulbricht, against the associated danger of change in the GDR through rapprochement, Honecker advanced his thesis: the recognition of the GDR by demarcation from the Federal Republic.'13 Ulbricht deplored Honecker's needling and remained unenthusiastic about demarcation, especially the renaming of institutions and organisations containing the word 'German'. For example, Deutschlandsender – the national radio station – was rechristened the 'Voice of the GDR', the state television channel was retitled 'GDR TV', and dozens of other associations and organisations were given the predicate GDR, with the exceptions of the SED, the FDGB and the FDJ. From then on, the German Academy of Sciences was called the 'Academy of Sciences of the GDR', and the National Front of Democratic Germany became the 'National Front of the GDR'. (A constitutional amendment in 1974, finally abandoned the concept of German nationhood and redefined the German Democratic Republic as a 'socialist state of workers and farmers'.) In her role as Education Minister, Margot Honecker joined in the demarcation process by banning schools from teaching the text of the national anthem, she left only the melody of Hanns Eisler's hymn untouched. (A line that mentioned a 'united fatherland' did not sit well with the dream of a 'proletarian nation').

By this point, aware that his days in power were numbered unless he acted against his ambitious protégé, Ulbricht stunned the Politburo on 1 July by sacking his heir and ordering him back to Party school for 'further